

WHEN A NATION FORGETS GOD

INTRO: Today we are celebrating Pentecost Sunday, which is the birthday of the church. Pentecost Sunday is my second favorite Sunday on the Church Calendar, after Easter Sunday. Every Pentecost Sunday in the last forty-two years of Pastoring I have preached on the Pentecostal experience. I am not going to do that this morning – We will celebrate the birthday of the church tonight at 6, with the rest of CT Nation.

This past Monday we celebrated Memorial Day – We remember those who have made the ultimate sacrifice for our freedom – Amid the family gatherings, cookouts, hamburgers and hotdogs, may we not forget the sacrifices that have been made for our freedom.

Just prior to Memorial Day we were made painfully aware of the depravity of man, and just how far America has drifted from the values

upon which it was founded with the killing of innocent children and adults inside a public school in Uvalde Texas. While these things take us by surprise, they shouldn't because...

A NATION THAT FORGETS GOD, CAN EXPECT A DOWNWARD SPIRAL

As we sit here this morning – SADLY – America is a fading shadow of what it one time was – I do not mean to be a negative Nancy but it is time for the Spiritual and public leaders of this nation to speak up and boldly, declare that this nation has lost its way – BECAUSE it has indeed, forgotten God!

We have:

- Taken prayer out of schools...
- Taken the Bible and Ten Commandments out of the public square...
- Murdered more than 61 million unborn children... (We have intentionally killed more than 20% of our national population – Not counting the children, grandchildren,

and great grandchildren they would have produced)

- Made fun of God and expelled Him from public policy, and even public conversation...
- Shook our fists in the face of God, believing our politicians know better than God, how to run a country... (How is that working for you?)
- Removed the pledge of allegiance from schools and sporting events...
- Excused athletes that refuse to stand for the national anthem... (Try explaining why this should be tolerated to a Gold Star family)

At one time during the history of the USA, there was a very healthy fear of the Lord. In this culture, social/secular life has become separate from spiritual life, and many have just completely moved away from spirituality altogether.

There was a time when we needed God so much that we walked with Him like children do with their fathers, when they are in a strange place. As God began to bless, we began to trust in those blessings more than in the One who gave them. For a while we still continued to give lip service to Him, yet our hearts were moving farther and farther away from Him. We have reached the point now that many are just in survival mode, and do not have time for God or spiritual things.

Listen to what the Bible predicts for a nation that reaches the point of Forgetting God: Psalm 9:15-17 (NKJV) ***“The nations have sunk down in the pit which they made; In the net which they hid, their own foot is caught. 16 The Lord is known by the judgment He executes; The wicked is snared in the work of his own hands. Selah. 17 The wicked shall be turned into hell, And all the nations that forget God.”***

- The pit we are in is of our own making...
“The nations have sunk down in the

pit which THEY have made...” (We cannot blame God – We are to blame)

- Our public policy has created a net that has entrapped us... *“The wicked is snared in the work of HIS OWN HANDS. Selah.”* (Selah = Pause and think about that)
- Our wickedness turns our very existence into a living hell... *“The wicked shall be turned into hell, And all the nations that forget God.”* (The person who forgets God can expect their lives to be turned into a living hell – Not because God is vindictive, but because they turn from God to Satan, and he is bent on destroying everything he touches – The same goes for a nation – A nation can’t forget God and expect His blessing – They should expect the destruction of the enemy, because they have opened the door to his diabolical schemes – Representative Jerry Nadler, Democrat from New York said, *“What any religious tradition describes as God’s will is no concern of this Congress.”*)

WHEN A NATION FORGETS GOD, IT CREATES A DATE WITH DISASTER

Romans 1:18-32 (NKJV) *“For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men, who suppress the truth in unrighteousness,¹⁹ because what may be known of God is manifest in them, for God has shown it to them.²⁰ For since the creation of the world His invisible attributes are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even His eternal power and Godhead, so that they are without excuse,²¹ because, although they knew God, they did not glorify Him as God, nor were thankful, but became futile in their thoughts, and their foolish hearts were darkened.²² Professing to be wise, they became fools,²³ and changed the glory of the incorruptible God into an image made like corruptible man—and birds and four-footed animals and creeping things.²⁴ Therefore God also gave them up to*

uncleanness, in the lusts of their hearts, to dishonor their bodies among themselves, ²⁵ who exchanged the truth of God for the lie, and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator, who is blessed forever. Amen.

²⁶ For this reason God gave them up to vile passions. For even their women exchanged the natural use for what is against nature. ²⁷ Likewise also the men, leaving the natural use of the woman, burned in their lust for one another, men with men committing what is shameful, and receiving in themselves the penalty of their error which was due. ²⁸ And even as they did not like to retain God in their knowledge, God gave them over to a debased mind, to do those things which are not fitting; ²⁹ being filled with all unrighteousness, sexual immorality, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness; full of envy, murder, strife, deceit, evil-mindedness; they are whisperers, ³⁰ backbiters, haters of God, violent, proud, boasters, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents, ³¹ undiscerning, untrustworthy,

***unloving, unforgiving, unmerciful;
32 who, knowing the righteous judgment of
God, that those who practice such things are
deserving of death, not only do the same but
also approve of those who practice them.”***

Look at this:

- The depravity of man (Not the wrath of God), is creating a date with disaster in the earth...
- Our current problems have more to do with God allowing man to date the devil, than His wrath being poured out... (Make no mistake about it, His wrath is going to be poured out, but I do not believe that is what we are seeing right now – The wrath of God will be unmistakable)
- We are seeing the results of man’s stubborn refusal to “***Retain God in our knowledge.***” (We are shocked by an 18 year-old child killing 19 people in Texas – It is a national

tragedy and a blight on America – But I am not sure it should come as much of a surprise to us – We have set the stage for these things because we have “*Forgotten God*” - We are now beginning to reap the grim consequences of our actions)

Paul writes to the Romans and gives them a list of things they can expect when they steadfastly refuse to acknowledge God in their public debate – Their culture – Their personal lives – These are indicators of the consequences of a nation that forgets God:

- Unrighteousness = Immoral character
- Fornication = Unhealthy lust of either sex
- Wickedness = To plot sin
- Covetousness = Fraudulent extortion, greed, or eager for gain
- Maliciousness = Bad, evil, harmful things

- Envy = Jealousy, spite, defilement, ruin, self-corruption
- Murder = To be slain – Slaughter
- Debate = Quarrels that are very contentious, strife, variance
- Deceit = Create a decoy – Filled with guile
- Malignity = Bad character that is filled with maliciousness
- Backbiters = Slanderers
- Haters of God = No respect or reverence for God
- Despiteful = Insults that lead to injury
- Proud = Taking a posture of being better than everyone else
- Boasters = Braggadocios – Bragging when there is nothing to brag about

- Inventors of evil things = Inventing evil, harmful, bad things
- Disobedient = Stubborn, willful, disobedience to authority – Lawlessness
- Without Understanding = Foolishly proceeding without having understanding of the facts
- Covenant Breakers = Breaking promises and contracts as a matter of doing business
- Lacking Natural Affection = Being heartless – Taking inhuman actions
- Implacable = Breaking truces without a second thought
- Unmerciful = Having no mercy – Merciless

Every single one of these things are being played out on our television screens every day, and being passed off as a normal way of doing things!

Unless this nation and world turns back to almighty God, it has a date with disaster!

A NATION THAT FORGETS GOD, CAN TURN BACK TO GOD

2 Chronicles 7:13-14 (NKJV) *“When I shut up heaven and there is no rain, or command the locusts to devour the land, or send pestilence among My people, ¹⁴ if My people who are called by My name will humble themselves, and pray and seek My face, and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin and heal their land.”*

When a person or a nation gets to the point of incurring the wrath of God, and we need God the most (Which is where we are), instead of digging our pit deeper and deeper, we need to return to our Creator and watch how He will put us back on the right path.

I will issue the following warning: If we do not come to our senses, we will begin to see the wrath of God on our personal lives, upon our country, and upon our world.

God oftentimes attempts to reach us by pressing us with the consequences of our own sin. This is an attempt by God to drive us to our knees so that we will return to Him, and receive His protection and blessings. I call it “*Last ditch mercy.*” Our Lord is so loving that even His judgment is an attempt at mercy. “*The destruction of the flesh is an attempt to save the soul.*”

If we choose to ignore His warnings, we will most certainly reap the sad consequences of our own rebellion and sinful ways.

Sooner or later sin will bring about its fruit in our lives, our nation, and the world.

God is so good that He allows us to make our own choices, but He also tells us what the right

choices are, and what the wrong choices are. While He allows us to make our own choices, He does not let us choose our own consequences!

He is so merciful that He warns us ahead of time of the consequences of our actions!

The prudent person weighs the decision, and the consequences, and chooses to live Godly in this present world! Proverbs 22:3 (NKJV) “***A prudent man foresees evil and hides himself, But the simple pass on and are punished.***”

CONCLUSION:

We must listen and pay attention to the Word of God and what He is trying to say to us in our day. If we do not pay attention to the Word of God, we will suffer the grim consequences of our actions.

Joel chapter one and two covers what I have been trying to say here, Joel 1:14 “***Consecrate a***

fast, Proclaim a solemn Assembly; Gather the elders And all the inhabitants of the land To the house of the LORD your God, And cry out to the LORD.”

If we do not listen and obey, the consequences will be devastating. If we obey, the results will be beautiful. Joel 2:18-27 gives us a helicopter view of what we can expect if we turn and/or return to the Lord:

- God will have mercy on His people....
- He will heal our land...
- He will send rain and cause fresh crops to grow...
- Everyone will have enough to eat...
- The invaders will be defeated and driven out...
- People will rejoice in their relationship with God once again...

I want to issue a solemn warning to the head of every family, to the church, and to the nation: It is time for us to turn and return to God, and do that which is right in the sight of the Lord!

Here is what I want us to do: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Every head of household commit to pray with your family every day - Repent for wrongs done – Repent as a nation - Commit to Godly living...
- Every head of every family commit to faithful (Not regular) church attendance...
- Every head of every family commit to Holy living and leading the family toward the things of God...
- Every head of every family commit to a systematic study of the Word of God every day – Sign up today for “*Walk Through The Word*”... (PLACE WALK THROUGH

THE WORD SIGN UP INFORMATION
ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF
THE SERVICE)

Joshua said, “*Choose you this day whom you will serve – The Gods of Egypt – The Gods of Canaan – Jehovah – As for me and my house, we WILL serve the Lord.*” (Family meetings)